

Westhampton Public Library Board of Trustees

Date: December 9, 2025

Time: 6:00 pm

Community Room Westhampton Public Library

In-Person Meeting

Documents discussed:

Director's Report 12-9-2025

FY27 Budget Worksheet

FY2027 Action Plan

Present: Meaghan Schwelm, Anne Marie O'Reilly, Angela Griefen, Alison Thirkield, Deb Estelle, Rick Tracy

Absent: Jackie Brodeur

Call To Order: 6:07 pm

Minutes from Last meeting: Approved

Angela Griefen moved to approve minutes from last meeting Deb Estelle seconded, approved unanimously.

Treasurer's Report

Building: \$3,594.48

State Aid: \$6,194.02

Deferred Town Monies (expenses): \$36,287.90

Deferred Town Monies (salaries): \$52,410.90

Gifts: \$21,982.48

Director's Report

Statistics:

Children's Programs: 10 children's programs with 106 attending

Adult Programs: 20 adult programs with 116 attending

Teen Programs: 1 teen programs with 2 attending

General Audience Programs: 0 general audience programs with 0 attending

Circulation: 1,580 (Dec 2024 – 1,649)

eBooks: 463 (Dec 2024 – 456)

Friends Report

The Friends reported that the Outdoor Access Committee, which is separate from the Friends, was not awarded the T-Mobile Hometown Grant for which they had applied, to partially fund the all access deck project. They are looking into status of getting metal railings from local metal worker.

Friends had asked Emily to create a one year budget for recurring programs/expenses. She presented this, and they approved.

Friends agreed to support landscaping costs up to 3k annually for the library, which will help decrease library budget, in light of town budget cuts.

Also discussed were: a draft mission statement for friends; Appalachian music concert; approved a second broom tying workshop. Fall Festival committee reported that the PTO has decided to no longer co-sponsor, due to trouble getting volunteers. Therefore proceeds will now be shared between the library and the Westhampton Historic Association.

Old Business

Meaghan reported that on December 3rd, the IMLS (Institute for Museum and Library Services) announced that all federal funds that were cancelled as a result of the Trump administration's previous executive orders will be reinstated. These cuts had affected services for those with disabilities, community grants, and statewide library research databases, heavily used by students. It will take time for the IMLS to do the work to restore the services that were halted.

Meaghan discussed department head meeting with finance committee regarding FY27 budget challenges and requests. The committee has requested the submission of two possible budgets, one for 'level service,' reduce costs where possible but maintain services as they are presently; the second to make a 12.5% reduction overall. Approaches and options to these two budgets were discussed.

Meaghan met with Cate Merlin, Head of State Programs for MBLC, and reported that past a certain point of budget cut, this will affect the state aid the library receives. To meet MAR, the town is expected to provide a library budget that meets or exceeds the average of the last three years budgets, plus 2.5%. Therefore \$136,409 would be our mar. If our 2027 budget is below this, we would have to apply for waiver, which is a long, tedious process, which must be done by the town, not the library. Can apply for a waiver up to 5 years in a row. Then will eventually the budget may need a big increase to get back to MAR depending on how deep the budget is cut. By forfeiting certification, the library will: receive no state aid, be ineligible for grants, and lose access to other services.

Meaghan will continue working on the two requested budgets.

FY27 action plan: Deb Estelle will meet with Meaghan to discuss how action plan items can be more detailed. Even though this is not the 5 year evaluation, such improved details can be incorporated in the annual update to be sent to MBLC, as required.

Anne Marie O'Reilly discussed the process of writing the annual report. It is a collaboration between a trustee and Meaghan, who provides the data. Anne Marie asked if another trustee would be interested in stepping into her role in future.

[New Business](#)

Meaghan reported that the library received its first state aid award of the year, the town should receive it within the next two weeks. The initial payment totals \$3,427.83

[Any other Business to come before the Trustees, not anticipated at the time of posting of this agenda](#)

Motion to adjoin made by Alison Thirkield; seconded by Deb Estelle. Approved unanimously.

Meeting Adjourned: 6:57

Next Meeting: January 9, 2026, 6 PM

Submitted By: Alison Thirkield